

Welcome to Zillow Preferred

57 minutes including practice · 33 screens

Edition 2026-09-14-preferred-foundations-v6

Before you begin

Eric opens Rep, selects the training and existing agents across teams, confirms the timezone, and creates the session. The creator is the default presenter and follow-up coach. Keep the private presenter console on your screen and share the separate presentation window.

Ask each selected agent to open the session through their own existing login. No second invitation is needed. Confirm that everyone can join and see the current activity. Submit written work before showing the model. Short answers are ungraded: collect the learner's reasoning without requiring corrections, keywords, or a retry to continue. Record exercises still check saved actions. Open activities under presenter control; advancing leaves unfinished work available for catch-up. Show help requests and connection problems separately.

In self-paced study, notes remain in the learner's browser until they choose to share them. In a live session, the presenter sees submitted answers and progress; unsubmitted writing stays private. Preserve first attempts; a retry after an example is assisted.

For remote practice, use the meeting platform's breakout rooms. Assign pairs or trios and rotate agent, buyer, and observer. In pairs, the buyer gives feedback. Every agent needs a speaking turn, one correction, and a retry. If a partner is absent, assign a coach or leave the observation outstanding.

Follow Up Boss practice

Stay in the assigned TrueHQ session for the whole class. Every learner uses their own login and simulated record. The People list is a reference image: review the controls and submit a navigation explanation here. The simulator opens inside a contact; no separate Follow Up Boss account or training pond is needed. This walkthrough does not verify hands-on search. Arrange any coach-observed search check separately after class. Preserve the repair diagnosis step.

Coach where to click, save, and verify. The server check validates saved actions; it does not judge note usefulness. After a passed record changes, check it again. Each exercise is a separate scenario. Give everyone a first attempt and use the discussion to explore reasoning; do not stretch the lesson to fill a clock.

Choose the tool

Where	Use it for	When
Details -> Stage / Timeframe	Actual progress / buyer's stated timing	After a meaningful conversation or event; review automatic changes.
Create Note -> contact history	Facts, preferences, outcome and unknowns	Read before outreach; save context after it.
Right -> Tasks	Work owed, with an owner and due date	When you promise a callback or another next action.
Right -> Appointments	A confirmed meeting	When date, time and participants are agreed; check duplicates.
Right -> Files	Relevant approved documents	When needed under the team's document process.
Right -> Deals	Transaction details	At the team's transaction milestone; today's case is an accepted offer.
Right -> Collaborators	Team member access	When someone helps; also give them a task and handoff.
Relationships	A co-buyer or related contact	When relevant to the customer; not team access.
Right -> Action Plans / Automations	Existing system workflows	Check prior messages before personal outreach; team manages setup.
Left -> My Agent; right -> Zillow Insights	Relationship status and eligible browsing context	Before personalized outreach; confirm rather than assume.
Top -> Inbox / Tasks / Calendar	Conversations / commitments / scheduled events	Start-of-day review, then update as work happens.

What each signal means

Connection status is separate from participation. A submitted answer is separate from a completed action. A record check is separate from writing quality. Record who observed a speaking turn and who reviewed it; a peer observation or self-check is not coach sign-off. Practice readiness, quiz certification, and activation remain separate.

Facilitator flow

01 / 33 · 0-1 min · Welcome to Preferred

Welcome to Zillow Preferred

Start with the Zillow program and its requirements before opening the Follow Up Boss examples. Confirm that everyone has joined their assigned TrueHQ session. Share the separate presentation window and keep your presenter console private. Explain any unfamiliar terms. Let each person answer and practice on their own screen. Written responses are for discussion, with no required keywords or corrections. Before class, create a new session with this updated lesson; existing sessions keep the lesson they were created with. Teach first, demonstrate second, and open the exercise only after the demonstration. Most slides are for presentation and discussion; only the marked activities need individual responses.

Zillow Preferred

How the program works, your agent agreement, ZIP preferences, monthly lead capacity, and the performance standards you must meet.

Follow Up Boss

How to find a contact, read the history, make calls and send texts, and use stages, notes, tasks, and appointments. We will also cover My Agent, Zillow Insights, and Smart Actions.

Practice and next steps

Watch your presenter demonstrate the record, then practice the same steps. Discuss when to use nurture and learn how to record an accepted offer. Finish by checking what you still need before leads begin.

Stay in your own TrueHQ live session for today's exercises. The practice records are built into this session. Your written answers help us understand your thinking; they do not block you from continuing.

Ask the room: Can everyone see this session in their own TrueHQ account?

02 / 33 · 1-2 min · Welcome to Preferred

How Zillow Preferred works

Explain the value of a Zillow connection without promising a closing or a fixed number of leads. Preferred and the Premier Agent app are not contradictory names: the app still supports the program. Introduce Day 1 as program readiness plus the working contact record; Days 2-4 deepen conversations, showings, and financing.

The program

Zillow Preferred is an invitation-only program, previously called Flex. Zillow connects you with potential buyers. A success fee applies when a transaction covered by your agreement closes. Review that agreement with your team.

Your role

Be available, understand the customer's request, agree on a useful next step, and keep the record current. The customer may be new to buying and may not know who is calling.

Growth

Your performance and the areas you serve help determine how many leads you receive. Tell the team how many new leads you can handle each month. The limit is 15 per month, or 10 in your first month. You can ask for fewer. The maximum is not a guaranteed number of leads.

Official reference: [Zillow Preferred](#)

Ask the room: What does the customer need from you that an automatic message cannot provide?

03 / 33 · 2-3 min · Welcome to Preferred

Before your lead funnel turns on

Eric's activation workflow requires the agent agreement. Show the actual invitation/account path only during a designated setup check, outside the simulated exercises. Zillow's public routing documentation describes team-managed controls; do not promise every agent an identical edit menu. Academy onboarding requires login and was not independently inspected. Confirm each learner's agreement, ZIP preferences, monthly capacity, and activation status with the team.

Agreement & account

Use your Zillow onboarding invitation and your own account. Complete the Zillow Preferred agent agreement and required onboarding. Ask the team to verify activation; completing this class alone does not activate routing.

ZIP preferences

When you log in for onboarding, set the ZIP preferences available to you. Choose areas you can serve well. Confirm your final routed ZIPs with the team lead; preferences and team routing must agree.

Capacity & availability

Tell the team how many new leads you can handle alongside your existing clients. The maximum is 15 per month, or 10 in your first month as a new hire. Confirm your number and availability before leads begin.

Official reference: [Program policies](#) · [Agent capacity & routing](#) · [Program benefits](#)

Ask the room: If your agreement is complete but the wrong ZIPs are routed, are you ready for leads?

04 / 33 · 3-5 min · Welcome to Preferred

How many leads should Sam take?

Keep this quick. Ask each agent to choose an answer. Explain that 15 is the monthly maximum and new hires are capped at 10 in month one. An agent can ask for fewer when their workload calls for it. Do not ask for a written explanation. A choice does not block them from continuing.

Sam already has a busy month

Sam has six active buyers, two evenings available for showings, and a day job on Tuesdays. Sam wants to take 20 new leads this month.

Our monthly limit is 15 leads. New hires can receive no more than 10 in their first month.

Ask the room: Should Sam ask for more than 20, 20, or fewer than 20 leads?

Participant task: Based on Sam's workload, should Sam ask for 20 new leads?

- Ask for more than 20 leads.
- 20 leads is a good number.
- Ask for fewer than 20 leads.

After submission: Ask for fewer than 20 leads. Fewer than 20. Our limit is 15 leads per month, or 10 in your first month. With six active buyers and limited availability, Sam may need fewer than the maximum.

The standards you must meet

Teach the team rule directly: one closing for every 30 leads taken. Keep the 25% minimum pickup rate. The monthly lead cap is 15; new hires have a maximum of 10 in their first month. These caps are limits, not a promise that everyone receives the maximum. Calling and texting through Follow Up Boss are mandatory. Ask agents to report access or calling problems before their leads begin.

1 in 30

Closing standard

Our team standard is one closing for every 30 leads you take.

25%+

Pickup rate

Answer at least 25% of incoming Zillow connection calls over the last 90 days. Answering 10 of 40 incoming calls is 25%. This measures the calls you answer, not how often buyers answer you.

Monthly lead limits

You can receive up to 15 leads per month. New hires can receive up to 10 in their first month. These are maximums, not guaranteed lead counts.

Follow Up Boss is mandatory

Work your leads in Follow Up Boss. All lead calls and texts must go through Follow Up Boss so the communication is saved on the contact record.

Meet 100% of your assigned Zillow Home Loans pre-approval target over three months. Ask your team lead what your target is. We cover lender introductions and buyer choice on Day 4.

The closing standard and monthly caps above are TRU team rules. [Zillow program standards](#)

Ask the room: What is your first-month lead limit, and where must you make your calls and send your texts?

Now, let's open Follow Up Boss

All class exercises remain in TrueHQ. This page teaches the real login path for the later readiness check. Never ask for passwords on screen. Have each learner verify real account access before activation and observe one search separately; completion here is not proof of live-system navigation. Confirm the team-approved email account and notification setup.

For this class, keep working in the TrueHQ simulator. These are the steps you will use in your real Follow Up Boss account after training.

Account setup

Confirm the correct team, name, phone and notifications. In your profile menu -> My Settings, connect the approved email/calendar account. Confirm FUB calling and mobile access with the team.

People · Inbox

People finds contacts and groups needing outreach. Inbox holds conversations that need your attention. Clicking a contact's name opens their record.

Tasks · Calendar · Reporting

Tasks tracks work owed; Calendar shows scheduled time; Reporting shows results. Admin settings belong to the team's setup process. You do not need to configure lead flow during a customer call.

Official reference: [Email & calendar setup](#) · [Inbox](#) · [Tasks](#)

Ask the room: Which screen would you open for an unread reply? Which for a promised callback?

07 / 33 · 7-8 min · Getting started in Follow Up Boss

Start in People

Stay in TrueHQ. The full reference image is already displayed on this page; scroll to inspect its controls. Point out People, search, smart lists, and filtering. Ask learners which controls they would use and how they would confirm the source and recent activity. This is a walkthrough, not a completed search task. The simulator begins inside a contact; no external account is needed for class.

Use the original product reference in the presentation.

Ask the room: Which control would you use to find a contact by name?

08 / 33 · 8-11 min · Getting started in Follow Up Boss

Find the tools on a contact record

Let each person explore at least Tasks, Appointments, and Collaborators before explaining the difference. The screenshot is a fictional record; the transparent hotspots identify tools without replacing FUB controls. Locations can differ in current accounts because sections can be reordered. Ask beginners to point, then experienced learners to explain the handoff. My Agent status is on the left; current Zillow Insights is on the right.

Ask the room: Where would you record a promise to call, versus a confirmed showing?

09 / 33 · 11-12 min · Work the connection

The welcome text has already gone out

The initial automated text is Eric's team workflow, not a universal Zillow default. Confirm its actual sender, content and trigger before class. Do not invent the exact text or send duplicate greetings. Demonstrate where calls/texts appear in the timeline. Explain the difference between an answered connection, a tour request, and an activity notification. Record the actual result, not the label you hoped to reach.

On arrival

TRU sends an automated initial text. Read the contact history to understand the inquiry and prior messages. An automated greeting does not mean you spoke with the buyer.

Your outreach

Use FUB's calling or texting controls on the record so communication is captured. Introduce yourself, your brokerage and the Zillow request. Invite an appropriate next step; listen before assuming readiness.

After the call

Save the outcome and context, confirm the true stage/timeframe, and create the next task or agreed appointment. Make your calls and send your texts through FUB. If a customer reaches you elsewhere, record what happened and continue the follow-up through FUB.

TRU standard: at least five unique personal calls or texts in the first seven days from arrival. Automated messages and emails do not count; day seven is not a stop rule.

Official reference: [Contact record](#) · [Action Plans](#)

Ask the room: An automatic text and a property view appear. What evidence of a personal conversation do you have?

10 / 33 · 12-13 min · Getting started in Follow Up Boss

Demo: update the stage after a call

Explain these three stages. On the next slide, use the shared presentation record to demonstrate the stage menu and save check before opening the activity for agents. Show the saved stage, then invite them to repeat the steps. Shared-screen demonstration does not count as an agent submission.

Choose the right stage

An unanswered call is Attempted contact. A real conversation with no meeting booked is Spoke with customer. A meeting with an agreed time and place is Appointment set.

Where to change it

On the left side of the contact record, find Stage in the Details panel. Click the current stage, choose the new one, and save it. In our simulator, the green check saves the change.

When to update it

Update the stage after the call, while the outcome is fresh. If an automatic update appears, check that it matches the conversation.

Watch the next screen

Your presenter will show Avery's record, select Appointment set, and save it. Avery has agreed to Saturday at 11 at the property. A tentative "Saturday might work" would not be enough.

Ask the room: First watch the stage change and save. Then you will try it.

11 / 33 · 13-16 min · Work the connection

Practice: save the appointment stage

Before opening this activity, demonstrate the required controls in the shared presentation window. Explain each click and show the saved result. Then click Open activity for agents. Open this activity for the learners. Each person works in their own simulated record inside this TrueHQ session; do not open Follow Up Boss or repeat the update in another account. Read this exercise's scenario: each is a separate fictional case, so changes do not carry into the next case. Let the learner find the control before offering a hint. Preserve the repair diagnosis step where present. Save and check the work here; in a live session the check submits the result to the presenter. A passed check validates the required saved actions, not note quality or overall readiness. Reopen and verify changes, and check again after editing a passed record.

Ask the room: Demonstrate first, then open the activity for everyone to practice.

Participant task: Watch the demonstration first. When your presenter opens the activity, try the same steps in your own record.

12 / 33 · 16-18 min · Work the connection

Recognize Smart Actions after a call

These are original official FUB help images, including their original colors and sample content. They are reference examples, not an exercise answer or a live SMS. Beta requires FUB Calling, call recording, active Zillow two-way integration and supported Zillow stages. Admin -> AI Settings controls suggest-only versus automatic behavior: early stages and appointments can be automatic; timeframe is always automatic. Verify team mode before demonstrating. Do not imply every learner receives the same prompt after every call.

Use the original product reference in the presentation.

Use the original product reference in the presentation.

After an eligible FUB call, Smart Actions may suggest a stage or appointment by text. Review the customer, action, and date before approving. Timeframe changes are automatic. No text does not mean there is no follow-up to do.

Official reference: [Smart Actions](#)

Ask the room: What would you verify before answering Yes?

13 / 33 · 18-19 min · Work the connection

Check what Smart Actions changed

Teach this as a worked example. Read the conversation, point out what was not confirmed, and show where the update can be reviewed. Do not request a written answer. Remind agents to use settings rather than replying STOP to FUB notifications.

“Friday could work” is not a confirmed meeting

Jamie says Friday afternoon might work, but needs to check with a partner. No time or property is agreed. A Smart Actions message suggests an appointment for Friday at 3. You also notice the move timeframe changed.

You still owe Jamie a call tomorrow. Inspect the proposed action and the actual conversation. Decide what to accept, decline, or correct, and what work remains yours.

Use the original product reference in the presentation.

Look for the purple update marker and change log. Check Appointments for duplicates; appointments created by FUB identify that in the description. Keep using the manual record controls when needed.

Official reference: [Smart Actions](#)

What to do here

Decline the proposed Friday appointment because Jamie has not confirmed it. Check the automatic timeframe change against the call. Keep tomorrow's callback task and confirm the meeting with Jamie before booking it.

Ask the room: A suggestion still needs to match what the customer agreed.

What My Agent means

Differentiate Preferred's initial 180 days from other Premier Agent configurations. FUB needs the Zillow two-way integration. Do not promise all search history, all internet activity, or permanent exclusive lead ownership. Explain the invitation/renewal state and ask the team to troubleshoot a missing relationship. A CRM connected status is not a signed representation contract.

Where to check

Open the contact -> Details -> My Agent status. This tells you whether the Zillow relationship is active, waiting for a response, or ending. The contact's stage tells you where you are in the buying process.

Why it matters

While the relationship is active, Zillow shows you as the customer's agent and can share their Zillow home-search activity with you. Check the expiration date. The customer can end this connection before the 180 days are up.

How to use it

Use what the customer is exploring to ask a better question and offer useful help. Maintain a real conversation. My Agent does not replace the required buyer or touring agreement.

Official reference: [My Agent · Touring agreements](#)

Ask the room: Can My Agent be Connected while the stage is still Attempted Contact?

See what the buyer is viewing on Zillow

Explain the right-side Zillow Insights panel and show the original screenshot. Walk through Taylor's example aloud. There is no written task on this slide.

Use the original product reference in the presentation.

A change worth asking about

Last Tuesday, Taylor said a three-bedroom home near work mattered most, but had not settled on a budget. Today, eligible Zillow activity shows saved homes in another ZIP and a higher price range.

You have no new reply from Taylor. A partner might be browsing, or the criteria might have changed. You do not know yet.

Look at the date range and the actual saved/viewed homes. Offer a useful comparison and ask whether the search has changed. Treat the price range as browsing context, not approved purchasing power.

Official reference: [Zillow Insights](#)

A useful message

"Taylor, last time we spoke you wanted a three-bedroom near work. Are those still your priorities, or would comparing another area be helpful?" Ask about the search without assuming that saved homes establish a budget.

Ask the room: Use the activity to prepare a helpful conversation, then confirm the details with the buyer.

Demo: save a useful contact note

Demonstrate Create Note on the next shared slide before opening the agent activity. Show the difference between a draft in the box and a saved entry. Read the example aloud and point out its specific facts. Do not invent budget or financing details.

Read the history first

The center of the record shows previous notes, calls, and texts. Before contacting someone, read the latest entries so you know what has already happened.

What to write

Record the buyer's request, useful preferences, what you agreed, and what still needs an answer. For Avery: buying with their sister, Olympia or Lacey, three or more bedrooms, and hoping to move before November. You promised two options by Thursday.

Where to save it

Type in the note box at the top of the contact history, then click Create Note. The note should appear in the history below. Text left in the box has not been saved.

Watch, then practice

On the next screen, your presenter will save a note and reopen the history to show it. You will then do the same. A note records the promise; a task reminds you to carry it out.

Ask the room: Watch where the saved note appears in the history.

Practice: write the conversation note

Before opening this activity, demonstrate the required controls in the shared presentation window. Explain each click and show the saved result. Then click Open activity for agents. Open this activity for the learners. Each person works in their own simulated record inside this TrueHQ session; do not open Follow Up Boss or repeat the update in another account. Read this exercise's scenario: each is a separate fictional case, so changes do not carry into the next case. Let the learner find the control before offering a hint. Preserve the repair diagnosis step where present. Save and check the work here; in a live session the check submits the result to the presenter. A passed check validates the required saved actions, not note quality or overall readiness. Reopen and verify changes, and check again after editing a passed record.

Ask the room: Demonstrate first, then open the activity for everyone to practice.

Participant task: Watch the demonstration first. When your presenter opens the activity, try the same steps in your own record.

Demo: schedule the next call

On the next shared slide, demonstrate the stage, saved note, and task form in that order. Show the name, assignee, date and time, then save. Open the learner activity only after the demonstration.

Task or appointment?

Use a task for work you owe, such as calling a buyer or checking parking. Use an appointment for a meeting the customer has agreed to attend at a specific time.

Open Tasks

On the right side of the record, find Tasks and click +. Name the action clearly, choose the responsible agent, and set a due date and time. Save the task.

Make it useful

“Call Avery tomorrow at 9:30 about the Juniper inquiry” is useful. “Follow up” leaves you guessing. If someone else takes over, make sure they have access to the contact and know what to do.

Watch, then practice

Your presenter will create the task on the next screen and show its date in the Tasks panel. Then you will record an unanswered call and schedule another attempt. An unanswered call does not tell you why the buyer missed it.

Ask the room: Watch the task appear with a due date before you start your own.

19 / 33 · 27-31 min · Record practice

Practice: set the missed-call task

Before opening this activity, demonstrate the required controls in the shared presentation window. Explain each click and show the saved result. Then click Open activity for agents. Open this activity for the learners. Each person works in their own simulated record inside this TrueHQ session; do not open Follow Up Boss or repeat the update in another account. Read this exercise’s scenario: each is a separate fictional case, so changes do not carry into the next case. Let the learner find the control before offering a hint. Preserve the repair diagnosis step where present. Save and check the work here; in a live session the check submits the result to the presenter. A passed check validates the required saved actions, not note quality or overall readiness. Reopen and verify changes, and check again after editing a passed record.

Ask the room: Demonstrate first, then open the activity for everyone to practice.

Participant task: Watch the demonstration first. When your presenter opens the activity, try the same steps in your own record.

20 / 33 · 31-33 min · Record practice

Which tool holds which part of the work?

Walk through this example yourself. Point to the matching areas on the contact map if someone needs help. No written response is needed.

A covering agent needs a usable handoff

Avery agrees to tour 406 Juniper on Saturday at 11. You promised to check parking with the listing agent tomorrow. A teammate will cover the showing and needs access to Avery’s background. Avery’s sister is a co-buyer, not a member of your team. You also received a relevant approved document.

You need to preserve the buyer’s preferences, record the meeting, assign your parking follow-up, and prepare the covering agent. No offer has been accepted.

Official reference: [Contact record](#) · [Tasks](#)

Note and appointment

Save the buyer's preferences in a contact note. Put the confirmed Saturday 11 showing in Appointments.

Task and collaborator

Make a dated task for checking parking. Add the covering teammate as a collaborator if they need contact access, and tell them what they are responsible for.

Files and relationships

Store the approved document in Files. Record the sister as a related contact or co-buyer. She is not a team collaborator. Add a Deal when the transaction reaches the team's agreed point.

Ask the room: Use this example to connect the tools you have just practiced.

21 / 33 · 33-39 min · Record practice

Define nurture: two different decisions

Give everyone quiet reading time and an independent response before discussion. For beginners, explain lead, stage, task, and automatic versus personal outreach using the facts on screen. Compare two different responses; ask "Which fact led you there?" rather than requiring a corrected answer. Explain the team's actual nurture rule and why it applies. Do not invent a timeline or imply that a later move date or silence automatically means Nurture. Maya has an agreed call due; ask what the learner would clarify before changing the relationship. Jordan has two personal attempts in the first week, not three: the automatic message does not count. TRU's first-week floor is at least five unique personal attempts from arrival; calls, including voicemail, and personal texts count. Do not turn that floor into a stop rule or impose a standard beyond week one. For experienced learners, use the changed-fact questions and ask what happens to an existing task if the stage changes. All written responses are ungraded; no rewrite is required to continue.

First, the terms: Nurture usually means staying in touch with someone who may buy later, using a follow-up plan that fits their needs. Your coach will explain when your team uses this stage. Moving a name into a different stage does not, by itself, create a follow-up plan. A task is the dated reminder assigned to the person who will take the next action.

Maya Chen · The move is later, but there is a promise due

How it started: Maya requested a tour through Zillow three weeks ago. You spoke and toured one home together. She is renting until March and said, "I probably won't move before my lease ends, but I want to understand the neighborhoods before I choose."

What happened this week: On Tuesday she sent two listings and asked which area would make the commute easier. You agreed to call Friday at 4 p.m. She replied, "Yes, talk then." She has not asked to stop hearing from you, and no second showing is booked.

What you inherit: The stage is Met with customer. A Friday 4 p.m. call task is assigned to you. A covering agent added, "Six months out - move to Nurture?" You have not discussed how often Maya wants contact or whether she would consider a suitable home sooner.

The decision: It is Friday at 3:45 p.m. Would you change the stage now, keep it while you clarify something, or take another step? What would you ask on the agreed call? Explain how your plan respects her timing and the promise already made.

Jordan Ellis • The record is quiet, but look at the attempts

How it started: Jordan requested information about 18 Cedar Street through Zillow on Monday morning. You called that morning, reached voicemail, and left a message offering to arrange a showing. You have never spoken with Jordan.

What happened this week: An automatic welcome text went out Monday. On Wednesday you personally texted, “I can help arrange a visit to Cedar Street - would Thursday afternoon or Saturday morning work?” There has been no reply. The record shows two property views on Thursday; it does not explain why Jordan viewed them.

What you inherit: It is Friday. The stage is Attempted contact. There is no next task. Another agent wrote, “No response - maybe not serious. Nurture?” The history contains one personal call and one personal text; the automatic message is separate.

The decision: What can you fairly conclude about Jordan’s interest? What would you do before treating this as a longer-term relationship? Choose a next attempt that offers a reason to respond, and explain when you would review the result. You do not know whether Jordan is busy, already helped, or no longer looking.

Ready for a harder question? How would your plan change if Maya asked for one call next month instead of Friday, or Jordan replied, “We bought yesterday”? Identify which new fact changes the action. Do not invent a universal number of days for moving someone to Nurture.

Ask the room: Which fact matters most to your next action, and which tempting conclusion is not supported yet?

Participant task: For Maya and Jordan, separate what you know from what you are assuming. Explain the next action you would take and why.

- For each buyer, what do you know from the record, what is still unknown, and would you change the stage yet? Explain your reasoning.
- What would you do next for each buyer? Include what you would say or ask, who owns the action, and when you would do it.
- What new information would make you change your plan? Name a specific answer or event, and when you would review the record.

Coach-led discussion. No automatic grade. Explain the team rule and ask for evidence; do not invent a nurture timeline.

22 / 33 • 39-40 min • Record practice

Repair Avery’s record

Give learners time to read, not just react to a stage label. Beginners can start with “What happened?” and “What still has to happen?” Experienced learners should explain the downstream cost: a teammate could prepare for an unconfirmed appointment or miss the needed call. Preserve the next exercise’s diagnosis step. Discussion has no keyword score; record controls still check saved actions. Demonstrate how to read this record before opening the repair activity. This combines familiar controls; it should not introduce a new workflow.

A hopeful plan became an appointment label

Yesterday Avery called about 406 and 422 Juniper Lane. Avery said, “Let’s plan on Thursday morning - I’ll confirm once I’ve checked with my sister.” No appointment was booked. You are now covering for the agent who took the call.

The record says Appointment set. The saved note says, “Talked. Interested. Follow up later.” There is no next task. Avery’s interest in the two properties is visible, but the note does not tell the next caller which homes were discussed

or what confirmation is still needed.

Before you edit, decide what the record claims, what the buyer actually confirmed, and what another agent needs next. In the following exercise, identify the record's problems first, then make your changes. Do not create a meeting just to make the label look right.

Before anyone edits, your presenter will point out the stage, the vague note, and the missing task. On the next screen, identify those problems, then use the same stage, note, and task controls you have already practiced.

Ask the room: What could the next agent mistakenly believe, and what would you need to clarify with Avery?

23 / 33 · 40-44 min · Record practice

Practice: repair Avery's record

Before opening this activity, demonstrate the required controls in the shared presentation window. Explain each click and show the saved result. Then click Open activity for agents. Open this activity for the learners. Each person works in their own simulated record inside this TrueHQ session; do not open Follow Up Boss or repeat the update in another account. Read this exercise's scenario: each is a separate fictional case, so changes do not carry into the next case. Let the learner find the control before offering a hint. Preserve the repair diagnosis step where present. Save and check the work here; in a live session the check submits the result to the presenter. A passed check validates the required saved actions, not note quality or overall readiness. Reopen and verify changes, and check again after editing a passed record.

Ask the room: Demonstrate first, then open the activity for everyone to practice.

Participant task: Watch the demonstration first. When your presenter opens the activity, try the same steps in your own record.

24 / 33 · 44-45 min · Record practice

Check the record before moving on

Ask agents to check their own work. Introduce the deal exercise: once an offer is accepted, update the stage and record the deal details.

Stage

Does it match the event, and did the change save?

Note

Does it explain what happened without guessing?

Task

Is the next action scheduled for a real date and time?

Handoff

Could another agent act on this record without asking you to explain it?

The handoff test

You will be unavailable when the next task is due. Your teammate has only this record. Could they identify the buyer's request, what was actually agreed, and the action they own? If not, name the missing fact rather than adding a more optimistic stage.

Ask the room: Which check would catch an unsaved stage?

Handle a reply from start to finish

Demonstrate missed calls, texts and emails as conversations. If a customer asks you to stop contacting them, respect the request and follow the team's communication process; do not solve it by changing a stage alone. Inbox permission is different from contact assignment. Do not let a cleared Inbox stand in for promised tasks.

Read the whole thread

Check My Inbox and the team inboxes assigned to you. Match the person before replying. Unread is a viewing state; opening a message does not complete the customer's request.

Preserve the outcome

Save important customer context on the contact record. An internal Inbox note stays in the conversation and is not added to the lead profile. A draft has not been sent.

Finish or hand off

Reply, handle the request or assign follow-up with an owner and due date. Close the conversation after handling it. Read status or closing an Inbox item does not update the contact stage.

Official reference: [Inbox](#)

Ask the room: A teammate sees an empty contact timeline but you wrote an Inbox note. Where should the customer context go?

Use Smart Lists and tasks together

New users: explain dynamic list with a concrete example, such as contacts with no recent communication. Experienced users: ask how a stale stage or automation could affect a filter. Avoid building or editing shared lists during class. Missing contact: clear filters, check All People/search, then ask the team about assigned/collaborator/pond access before creating a duplicate.

Inbox + due work

Handle incoming replies, missed calls and due/overdue commitments. Confirm today's appointments. A specific promise needs a dated task and an owner.

People -> Smart Lists

Saved filters identify contacts by criteria such as stage or last communication. They update as records change. Use the team's assigned lists; inspect filters if someone is missing.

Read before contacting

Confirm identity, source, owner, last conversation, recent activity and next task. Being absent from a list does not prove follow-up is done; access and filters affect what you see.

Official reference: [Smart Lists](#) · [Tasks](#)

Ask the room: Why might Avery disappear from a Smart List without being deleted?

Demo: add the accepted offer as a deal

Use the shared presentation form to show the blue +, property/address, price and closing date. Save it and show the new deal. Explain that the contact stage also changes to Under contract. The next slide lets agents repeat these steps and add the note and next task.

Ask the room: After the demonstration, you will save the accepted-offer record yourself.

Practice: record the accepted offer

Before opening this activity, demonstrate the required controls in the shared presentation window. Explain each click and show the saved result. Then click Open activity for agents. Open this activity for the learners. Each person works in their own simulated record inside this TrueHQ session; do not open Follow Up Boss or repeat the update in another account. Read this exercise's scenario: each is a separate fictional case, so changes do not carry into the next case. Let the learner find the control before offering a hint. Preserve the repair diagnosis step where present. Save and check the work here; in a live session the check submits the result to the presenter. A passed check validates the required saved actions, not note quality or overall readiness. Reopen and verify changes, and check again after editing a passed record.

Ask the room: Demonstrate first, then open the activity for everyone to practice.

Participant task: Watch the demonstration first. When your presenter opens the activity, try the same steps in your own record.

What to do after an offer is accepted

Explain the success fee as a signed-agreement obligation, not a universal flat rate. Zillow's current compliance page requires closing documents within four calendar days for eligible transactions; the team must name the responsible coordinator and handoff. FUB is the daily CRM, while Zillow remains necessary for this reporting and onboarding. Seller-connection agents need their additional program training; Day 1 does not certify seller-course completion.

In Follow Up Boss

Record the actual stage, accepted-offer details, deal and next task under the team's process. Keep the transaction coordinator informed about changes.

In Zillow Premier Agent

Final transaction details and closing documents still need the Zillow workflow. A FUB Deal or file alone does not finish Zillow reporting.

Know who owns it

Confirm who logs the transaction, uploads closing documents and handles the success fee. Escalate a pre-existing-relationship or referral question promptly; do not assume it removes an obligation.

Official reference: [Program standards](#) · [Program policies](#)

Ask the room: If the FUB deal says Closed, what still needs verification?

A practical start to your workday

Present this as a simple daily routine. Discuss how to get help when a new lead and a promised call arrive together. No written response is needed.

Check what needs an answer

Open Inbox for new replies and missed calls. Check today's appointments so you know when you need to be available.

Keep existing promises

Open Tasks and look for overdue work and calls due soon. If you cannot make a promised call, arrange coverage and leave a clear note.

Work new leads

Read the new inquiry and any automatic messages. Call through FUB, save the outcome, and schedule the next step. Use your team's Smart Lists to keep working your contacts.

Ask the room: Inbox, appointments, due tasks, then your contact lists.

Before you leave a contact record

Recap the record workflow as a presenter. Ask for questions before the final readiness check.

Stage

Does the stage match what actually happened?

Note

Did you save the important facts and what you agreed?

Next step

Is there a task with a date and owner, or a confirmed appointment?

Final check

Reopen what you saved. A teammate should be able to tell what happened and what to do next.

Ask the room: This is the same check after every meaningful conversation.

Before you start receiving leads

End the simulated class here. Arrange a separate, coach-observed real-account check before turning on leads; use an approved test contact, not edits to a real buyer. Record unresolved access/setup questions for the team. Do not mark agreement signed, ZIPs saved or activation complete based on this written answer. New saved sessions must use this edition.

Zillow ready

Agreement and onboarding complete. ZIP preferences reviewed. Monthly lead count and availability confirmed with the team: up to 15 leads, or up to 10 in your first month. Routing activation verified.

FUB ready

Own login works. Calling and texting through FUB work. Notifications and your approved email/calendar are checked. Find a contact, locate its tools, and understand the connected Zillow report.

Work ready

Read the history. Call or text through FUB. Save a clear note, the correct stage, and the next task or appointment. Check automatic updates against what the buyer actually said.

Ask the room: What is the one unresolved item that could prevent you from handling your first connection?

Participant task: What is ready, what remains uncertain, and who will help you resolve it before leads begin?

- What is ready, what remains uncertain, and who will help you resolve it before leads begin?

33 / 33 · 56-57 min · Ready for leads

Your reference desk

Sources reviewed September 13, 2026. Use the live official pages for updates. Team-specific onboarding invitations, ZIP edit rights, routing allocations, automation text and Smart Actions mode must be checked in the actual account. Public Zillow Academy onboarding is login-protected; no completion claims are made. Coach new agents on the needed task instead of asking them to read every linked article.

Official reference: [Zillow Preferred](#)

Official reference: [Program standards](#)

Official reference: [Agent capacity & routing](#)

Official reference: [Program benefits](#)

Official reference: [Program policies](#)

Official reference: [Smart Actions](#)

Official reference: [My Agent](#)

Official reference: [Zillow Insights](#)

Official reference: [Contact record](#)

Official reference: [Inbox](#)

Official reference: [Smart Lists](#)

Official reference: [Tasks](#)

Official reference: [Email & calendar setup](#)

Official reference: [Performance report](#)

Official reference: [Action Plans](#)

Official reference: [Touring agreements](#)

Ask the room: Which reference would you use when an expected Smart Actions text does not arrive?

After the workshop

Live session: closing the session creates assignments for recall within 24 hours, a fresh case in three days, and coach review in seven days. The session creator owns follow-up across the selected teams unless a different authorized coach was selected. Confirm the displayed session timezone. Due and overdue work appears in Rep; the daily digest links to work due or awaiting review.

Self-paced study: arrange those same checks with a coach. If there has been no relevant client opportunity, use a new fictional case and mark real-work application as not yet observed.

Keep the first attempt and correction. A useful follow-up asks whether the agent can apply the skill in another case.

References and certification

Updated September 13, 2026 from the existing Day 1 workshop and Eric's approved interactive-training plan. TRU sales doctrine remains the source for coaching the first call and follow-up.

- [Zillow Preferred FAQ](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- [Zillow Preferred Program Standards](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- [Agent Capacity and Lead Routing](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- [Zillow Preferred Program Benefits](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- [Zillow Preferred Compliance Policies](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- [Smart Actions](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- [My Agent Status](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- [Zillow Insights in Follow Up Boss](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- [Lead Profile Overview](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- [Inbox Overview](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- [Smart Lists Overview](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- [Tasks Overview](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- [Connecting Your Email & Calendar](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- [Zillow Preferred Agent Performance Report](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- [Action Plans Overview](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- [Zillow Touring Agreement](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13

Existing quizzes, pass thresholds, and certification records continue through the normal Rep course flow. The presentation link is not a certification attempt.